

The croupier at the roulette table does not claim that he knows something about the order in which the numbers will come up. He just sees to it that the bets are properly paid off and that the house isn't gypped—which is a job requiring competence.

But no Wall Streeter is willing to be just a croupier. He insists that he is also a prophet, a scholar, and a magician with money.

THE BANKERS AND THE THINKERS

Let us start at the top and work down—a not unusual Wall Street method of pursuing a career. Let us consider the cream of the crop—the truly conservative banker.

This man is an impressive specimen, diffusing the healthy glow which comes of moderation in eating, living, and thinking. He sits enthroned behind a mahogany desk and says, with varying inflections and varying contexts, "No." He is at the top or close to the top of one of those financial empires whose destinies have been guided with such prudence, shrewdness, and soundness that today the Great House has darn near as much money as it had in 1900.

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At that, I believe this fellow does the best job of the lot. Years have gone by, and he hasn't been indicted—there have not even been any scandals; some of the accounts haven't lost anything, and the rest have at least lost their money gradually and respectably. When the great man is asked for investment